James Chang

Senior Product Manager

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A career of product instinct. Shipping now at AI speed.

Summary

Fifteen years sourcing products across Asia and the US taught me what real importers need. A decade in product management at Gannett/LocaliQ, Sunrise, MEDL, and earlier roles taught me how to ship.

Now I combine both — founding Aleph Co. to build compliance tooling for the sourcers I used to be, while shipping six other products in parallel because the operator problems I know best aren't confined to one market.

MBA from USC Marshall (2012), CSPO, and a lifetime food blog at The Thirsty Pig. Based in Los Angeles.

Experience

Aleph Co. — Founder & Operator

2025 – Present · Los Angeles, CA

- Founded and operate Aleph Compliance, a SaaS platform for US importers covering FDA FSVP, CPSIA/CPC, California Prop 65, and multi-state PFAS regulations.
- Shipping six other products in parallel under Aleph Co. — see Current projects for the portfolio and /work/ for deep-dives.

Gannett / LocaliQ / USA Today Network — Senior Product Manager

2022 – 2024 · Woodland Hills, CA

- Shipped Scheduling product 0→1 in year one: 4,900 free accounts + 400 paid, driven by prioritizing calendar sync and SMS notifications ahead of AI features.
- Owned product for LocaliQ's SEO offerings and its GenAI tooling portfolio for SMB customers.
- **Byline:** Appointment Scheduling Simplified: Introducing Our (Free) Scheduling Software · LocaliQ Blog · Feb 2023
- **Press:** LocaliQ Launches New Scheduling Management Software for Small Businesses · Gannett / USA Today press release · Dec 2022

Sunrise Integration — Project Manager

2020 · Los Angeles, CA

- Led development team for the WarehouseConnector SaaS platform launch.
- Managed client delivery on Jira across multiple ecommerce integrations, including TeeLaunch and SAFIOsolutions.

Movley — Operations & Product Manager (now Ops Ninja)

2019 · Los Angeles, CA (Remote)

- Product-managed the website, client portal, and inspector portal.
- Managed overseas teams across India, the Philippines, and China. Built budgets and operating policy.

MEDL Mobile — Product / Project Manager

May 2018 – Dec 2018 · Irvine, CA

- Managed creative and software projects for mobile and web applications. Vetted ecommerce and signature-API vendors.

Education

USC Marshall School of Business

Master of Business Administration (MBA), 2012. Class President.

Certifications

Certified Scrum Product Owner (CSPO), Scrum Alliance · 2019

Product Management Certificate, Product School · 2018

Data-Driven Product Management, LinkedIn Learning · 2024

Product Management: Building a Product Roadmap, LinkedIn Learning · 2024

Technology for Product Managers, LinkedIn Learning · 2024

Toggl Hire Product Development · 2024

Appcues Basics · 2023

Jasper Certified · 2023

HubSpot Inbound Certification · 2019

Google Analytics for Beginners · 2018

Skills

Product: 0→1 development, roadmapping, discovery & user research, A/B testing, GenAI integration, native-mobile PM

Tools: Jira, Linear, Figma, Notion, Prisma, Supabase, Stripe, Claude API, GitHub, Vercel, Railway

Engineering (hands-on): TypeScript, Python, Next.js, Astro, Tailwind, FastAPI, Socket.IO, Prisma · **AI-assisted development** (Claude Code, MCP, agent workflows)

Domains: B2B SaaS, regulatory compliance, fantasy sports, food & dining, global supply chain & sourcing

Languages: English (native), Mandarin (fluent), Taiwanese (fluent)

Current projects

Seven products in production across compliance SaaS, AI experiments, marketplaces, native mobile, and long-form publishing.

Aleph Compliance
Product compliance for US importers. FDA FSVP, CPSIA/CPC, California Prop 65, multi-state PFAS — one platform.

Bahtzang Trader
AI trading-decision experiment using Claude Sonnet. Paper-trading sandbox — not a live trading service.

TableDrop
Restaurant reservation marketplace. Sellers list hard-to-get tables, buyers purchase them. Next.js + Stripe + Playwright.

The Fantastic Leagues
Fantasy baseball with league-context AI. 26 feature modules, 730 tests, 8 AI features (Gemini + Claude), live auction WebSockets.

The Judge Tool
Digital KCBS BBQ competition judging. Real-time tabulation, audit trails, 16,424 LOC + 113 tests shipped in 20 days.

Tastemakers
iOS restaurant-review app. Cross-platform build — iOS, Android, web. Currently paused.

The Thirsty Pig
Food and travel blog since 2007. 2026 rebuild: 923 posts recovered from the Wayback Machine, 1,649 Instagram posts archived, 2,900+ pages.

Volunteer Experience

Chinese American Museum Board Member

Feb 2026 – Present · Los Angeles, CA

Serving on the board of the Chinese American Museum in downtown Los Angeles, the first museum in the United States dedicated to the history and ongoing story of Chinese Americans.

James Chang · Los Angeles, CA

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